

'Stevens'

This hybrid, bred for productivity and disease resistance, is characterized by its vigorous habit and large red berries. Its leaves are larger than other varieties' and yields can be double those of wild cranberries. The tangy fruits ripen after 'Ben Lear' but before 'Howes'.



unsuitable for containers



spring or early fall



good resistance



hardy



self-fertile



early to mid-fall

'Early Black'

This is one of the easiest varieties to grow, since it is disease- and frost-resistant. The large, bell-shaped fruits are such a dark red that they are almost black, and they have a relatively sweet flavor. In fall, the blunt-tipped foliage turns a deep red.



suitable for containers



year round



good resistance



hardy



self-fertile



late summer to early fall

'Ben Lear'

Taken from the wild in Wisconsin in the 1900s, this variety produces early burgundy berries that are prized for sauces. Shrubs form a spreading mat of 8-10 in (20-25 cm), and are good ground cover under taller, acid-loving shrubs.



unsuitable for containers



spring or early fall



some resistance



hardy



self-fertile



early to mid-fall

'Howes'

This bright red berry originated in Massachusetts and is known for its long storage. The firm, tart fruits are oval and ripen later than other varieties. The ground-hugging shrubs benefit from winter snow cover or leaf mulch.



unsuitable for containers



spring or early fall



some resistance



hardy



self-fertile



mid-fall